

Learn more

1. Introduction to the Blog

1.1 Why This Blog Exists

This blog was created to raise awareness about child poverty, homelessness, and the daily struggles faced by undocumented families in France. Behind every child asking for help in the streets, there is often a story of instability that many people do not fully see or understand.

Our goal is not only to inform people, but also to encourage compassion, understanding, and action. Many families face difficulties accessing stable housing, education, healthcare, and social support. As a result, some children grow up in unsafe conditions and experience exclusion from society at a very young age.

Through this blog, we want to educate the public about these realities while sharing some possible solutions and useful information. We believe that awareness is the first step toward change. By speaking openly and respectfully about these issues, we hope to help create a more supportive and inclusive society for every child.

1.2 Our Vision

Our vision is simple: every child deserves safety, education, and hope for the future.

We believe that children should grow up in environments where they feel protected, supported, and loved. Poverty should never prevent a child from going to school, accessing basic needs, or feeling included in society.

Through education, social support, and community solidarity, we hope to help families move from survival to stability. We believe that long-term change begins with empathy, inclusion, and equal opportunities for all children.

By raising awareness and encouraging collective action, we hope to contribute, even in a small way, to a society where every child has the chance to live with security, confidence, and dignity.

2. Understanding Child Poverty

2.1 What Is Child Poverty?

Child poverty refers to situations where children do not have access to the basic resources necessary for a safe and healthy life. Like stable housing, sufficient food, healthcare, education and many others .

Poverty is not only about money. It can also affect a child's physical health, mental well-being, social life, and future opportunities. Some children experience material poverty, while others face social exclusion, insecurity, or unstable living conditions that deeply impact their development.

In France, many families struggle with rising living costs, housing difficulties, and unemployment. Vulnerable families, especially the undocumented, are often exposed to even greater challenges because they may have limited access to financial support and public services.

Child poverty can sometimes remain invisible. While some children openly face homelessness or begging in the streets, others suffer silently in overcrowded housing, temporary shelters, or unstable environments. Understanding these realities is essential in order to build a more supportive and inclusive society.

2.2 Child Poverty Among Undocumented Families

Many undocumented families face difficult living conditions every day. Without documents, it can be very hard for parents to find stable jobs, rent a home, or access certain services.

Because of these difficulties, some families move frequently between temporary shelters, hotels, or emergency accommodation. For children, this often means growing up without a place they can truly call home.

Getting enough food can also become a daily challenge. Some families rely on charities and food distributions to get by. In some cases, parents choose to eat less so their children can have enough to eat.

Life in these conditions can be especially difficult for the little ones . They may feel different from other children or worry about their family's situation. Behind every child living in poverty, there is a story that is rarely seen by the public. Understanding these realities is important because no child should have to grow up worrying about basic needs.

2.3 Why Some Families Are Forced to Beg

Many people see families asking for money in the street, but few know what their daily lives are really like. It is easy to judge a situation from the outside without understanding what led to it.

For some families, begging becomes a way to cover immediate needs when other solutions are not available. What may seem like a simple request for money often reflects a much deeper struggle.

For children, spending time in the street can be particularly difficult. While other children are playing, studying, or enjoying a stable routine, some are exposed to long hours outdoors and challenging living conditions.

Looking beyond first impressions helps us better understand the reality faced by some families. Every child deserves the opportunity to grow up in a safe environment where their needs, education, and well-being come first.

2.4 The Consequences on Children

Growing up in difficult circumstances can affect much more than a child's daily life. It can influence the way they see themselves, others, and their future.

When children spend their early years worrying about problems that no child should face, they may miss important moments of learning, discovery, and personal development. Instead of focusing on their dreams and ambitions, they are often forced to think about challenges beyond their age.

Over time, these experiences can reduce confidence and make it harder for children to believe in their own potential. Some may feel left behind while watching other children enjoy opportunities that seem out of reach.

This is why early support is so important. Every child deserves the chance to grow, learn, and build a future without being limited by the circumstances they were born into.

3. Education & Childhood

3.1 Why Education Matters

Education is one of the most powerful tools for changing a child's future. School is not only a place to learn mathematics, science, or languages; it is also where children discover their abilities, develop their interests, and build important life skills.

For many children facing difficult circumstances, education represents hope. It can open doors to new opportunities and help break the cycle of poverty from one generation to the next.

Every child deserves the chance to learn, grow, and prepare for a better future.

3.2 Do Undocumented Children Have Access to Education in France?

Many people believe that children without legal residency papers cannot attend school. In reality, French law guarantees access to education for all children living in the country.

Schools cannot refuse a child because of their nationality or immigration status. This right is essential because education helps ensure that every child has the opportunity to learn and develop.

However, some families may need support when completing registration procedures or understanding the education system.

3.3 Challenges Faced at School

Although children can attend school, their experience is not always easy.

Some arrive in France without speaking French, making lessons and communication more difficult at first. Others may struggle to adapt to a new environment, culture, or way of life.

In some situations, children may feel isolated or different from their classmates. These challenges can affect participation, motivation, and academic progress.

With support from teachers, families, and community organizations, many children are able to overcome these difficulties and succeed.

3.4 School Supplies & Daily Needs

Success at school also depends on having the necessary resources.

Items such as notebooks, backpacks, pens, appropriate clothing, and transportation may seem simple, but they play an important role in a child's daily life. Without them, participating fully in school can become more difficult.

Access to technology is also increasingly important. Computers and internet connections are often needed for homework, research, and communication with teachers.

Providing these basic resources helps ensure that every child can focus on learning rather than worrying about what they lack.

4. Health & Well-Being

4.1 Physical Health Challenges

Good health is something many people take for granted, yet it can become a daily challenge for children living in poverty.

When basic needs are difficult to meet, children may not always have enough food, access to a doctor, or a safe place to live. As a result, some health problems may become more serious over time.

Children who spend long periods in the street or move frequently from one place to another may also face additional difficulties, especially during winter. Cold weather, lack of rest, and difficult living conditions can affect their growth and overall well-being.

Every child deserves access to healthcare and the basic resources needed to grow up healthy, safe, and supported.

4.2 Mental Health & Emotional Well-Being

A child's well-being depends not only on physical health but also on feeling safe, supported, and able to look toward the future with confidence.

Growing up in difficult circumstances can place a heavy emotional burden on children. Worries that adults normally carry—such as housing, money, or family difficulties—can sometimes become part of a child's everyday life.

Over time, this pressure may affect self-confidence, relationships, and the ability to focus on learning and personal growth. While these effects are not always visible, they can be just as important as physical health challenges.

Providing emotional support and a stable environment can help children develop resilience and regain a sense of security.

4.3 Children Experiencing Homelessness

For a child, home is more than a place to sleep. It is a place of safety, routine, and stability.

When children experience homelessness, many aspects of daily life become more difficult. Simple things such as resting, studying, keeping personal belongings, or maintaining regular routines can become a challenge.

Without a stable environment, children may struggle to feel secure and plan for the future. The uncertainty of not knowing where they will sleep or what tomorrow will bring can have a lasting impact on their well-being.

This is why providing safe housing is about much more than offering a roof. It helps create the stability that every child needs to grow, learn, and thrive.

5. Rights & Legal Information

5.1 Rights of Undocumented Families in France

In France, even when families do not have legal residency papers, children still have important basic rights.

All children have the right to education. Schools must accept children regardless of their administrative situation. This is a protected principle in France, meaning that access to school does not depend on immigration status.

Emergency healthcare can also be available in urgent situations, even for people without regular administrative status. The goal is to ensure that no child is left without medical attention when it is needed.

However, many families are not fully aware of these rights or do not understand how to access them. As a result, some children and parents do not receive support that is already available.

5.2 How to Access Help Safely

For families in difficult situations, finding support is not always simple.

Help can exist through different organizations such as charities, social workers, or local support services. These services may offer food assistance, school support, housing help, or guidance with administrative steps.

In urgent situations, emergency services can also provide temporary solutions, especially when children have no safe place to stay.

Many families feel unsure or afraid to ask for help, which is why access to clear and simple information is very important.

5.3 Administrative Challenges

Even when rights exist, accessing them can be difficult.

Many families face complicated forms, long procedures, or documents that are hard to understand. This can delay or block access to important support.

Language barriers and unstable living conditions can make these difficulties even worse. Some families move frequently or do not receive clear information, which increases confusion.

In many cases, the main challenge is not the absence of help, but the difficulty in understanding how to reach it.

5.4 Useful Resources

In France, different types of support exist for families facing poverty or homelessness.

These can include emergency shelters, food distributions, free meals, hygiene support, medical care, and assistance for children at school.

Access to clear and reliable information can play an important role in helping families understand their options and improve their situation.

This can make a real difference for children who need stability, safety, and support in their daily lives.

6. Human Stories & Testimonials

6.1 Family Stories

Behind every situation described in this blog, there are real families trying to manage difficult daily lives.

Some families move often from one temporary place to another, trying to find safety and stability. For children, this means constantly adapting to new environments, new schools, and new routines. Even small moments of normal life can feel uncertain.

Many children in these situations still try to continue school, make friends, and keep a sense of normality, even when their living conditions are unstable. Their strength often goes unnoticed, even if their situation is very difficult.

These stories are not rare cases, but realities that exist in many cities.

6.2 Everyday Experiences

Life in difficult conditions is not only about big problems, but also about small daily challenges.

Something as simple as having a quiet place to sleep, doing homework, or keeping personal belongings safe can become difficult. These small things, which many people take for granted, can become constant worries.

Despite this, many children and parents continue to do their best to maintain routines, go to school, and keep moving forward.

6.3 What These Situations Teach Us

These realities show that poverty is not just about money, but about stability, safety, and opportunity.

They remind us that behind every situation, there are human lives, not statistics. Children in these circumstances do not need judgment, but understanding and attention.

Small actions, awareness, and support from society can make a meaningful difference in their daily lives and future.

7. Awareness & Misconceptions

7.1 Common Myths About Undocumented Families

("They don't want to work"/"Children cannot go to school"/"Begging is a choice")

Public discourse surrounding undocumented migrants is frequently clouded by political rhetoric and media stereotypes. When applied to families with young children, these misconceptions create a culture of suspicion that alienates vulnerable populations. To build effective social projects, we must first dismantle these three pervasive myths:

Myth 1: "They choose to live on the streets and beg rather than work."

- **The Structural Reality:** In France, the right to work is strictly tied to legal residency status. Under the *Code de l'entrée et du séjour des étrangers et du droit d'asile* (CESEDA), undocumented migrants are legally prohibited from entering the formal labor market. Begging (*la mendicité*) or collecting scrap metal is never a cultural preference or a lazy choice; it is a punishing, last-resort economic survival strategy to

buy infant formula, diapers, and basic food when all legal income streams are blocked.

Myth 2: "Undocumented children do not have the right to attend school."

- **The Legal Reality:** French domestic law and international treaties are perfectly clear on this point. Article L131-1 of the French Education Code states that education is compulsory for all children residing in France between the ages of 3 and 16, **regardless of their parents' administrative or legal status**. School structures cannot legally deny admission based on a lack of residency papers.

Myth 3: "Providing help creates a 'pull factor' that attracts more illegal migration."

- **The Human Reality:** Extensive sociological data shows that families do not choose to cross borders because of the availability of soup kitchens or basic charity. They flee catastrophic push factors—extreme systemic poverty, localized violence, ethnic discrimination, or climate displacement. Denying children food or blankets does not deter migration; it simply inflicts state-sanctioned trauma on minors.

To read in-depth analyses of current migration laws and how legal codes affect families in Europe, explore the policy briefs published by the [Migration Policy Institute \(MPI\)](#).

7.2 Understanding Reality

Structural poverty/Lack of opportunities/Social exclusion

Fighting stereotypes is the first step toward real change. When we replace judgment with compassion, we stop seeing "undocumented statistics" and start seeing children who need protection, education, and safety. Restoring human dignity means acknowledging their existence, respecting their resilience, and defending their right to a stable childhood.

Inspiration Link: To see how major NGOs fight stereotypes and explain systemic poverty in France, check out the resources and reports on [Secours Catholique](#) or [La Cimade](#).

7.3 The Importance of Compassion

Human dignity/Respectful support/Fighting stereotypes

Restoring Human Dignity

At the core of this project is a fundamental philosophical framework: **a child is a child first, and a migrant second**. The United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC) which France ratified in 1990 explicitly mandates that the best interests of the child must be a primary consideration in all actions concerning minors. Compassion is not mere pity; it is the active recognition of human dignity. By fighting stereotypes, our association aims to re-humanize these families in the eyes of the public, shifting the narrative from a security problem to a humanitarian duty.

- **Preserving Human Dignity:** Living on the streets or in a squat strips a family of their privacy, autonomy, and self-respect. We hope to contribute to restoring that dignity. This means looking people in the eye, addressing them by their names, and ensuring that our support never feels like patronizing charity, but rather a horizontal act of human solidarity.
- **Providing Respectful Support:** Respectful aid means listening to what families actually need instead of assuming we know what is best for them. It means respecting their cultural backgrounds, their dietary choices during food drives, and their privacy by never taking or publishing photos of vulnerable children without informed, legal consent.
- **Actively Fighting Stereotypes:** Deconstructing biases is a daily battle. By using our blog and social platforms to share factual data, we actively dismantle the harmful rhetoric that criminalizes poverty. Compassion becomes a tool for social justice when it inspires the public to challenge systemic discrimination and see the child before the paperwork.

8. Solutions & Social Action

8.1 What Associations Can Do

Emergency aid/Educational support/Street outreach/Legal guidance

Immediate and Structural Support

Non-profit organizations act as critical intermediaries, stepping in where state mechanisms fall short or create bureaucratic barriers. To effectively assist undocumented children, an association must deploy a multi-tiered operational strategy:

- **Emergency Humanitarian Aid:** Meeting immediate physiological needs. This includes organizing mobile food trucks, distributing clean drinking water, setting up hygiene stations, and providing cold-weather gear (sleeping bags, thermal jackets) to children living on the streets.

- **Educational Facilitation & Mediation:** Acting as a bridge between families and the national education system. Associations help parents compile the necessary documents for school enrollment, challenge unlawful school rejections at the town hall (*mairie*), and provide school supplies to ensure children blend in seamlessly with their peers.
- **Street Outreach (Maraudes):** Deploying mobile teams of volunteers, social workers, and medical professionals directly into public spaces, metro stations, and encampments to establish trust, monitor child wellness, and offer a human connection.
- **Legal Advocacy & Orientation:** Partnering with volunteer lawyers and legal experts to help parents understand their rights, navigate the *préfecture* administrative application processes, and request regularisation based on criteria like the length of time their children have been enrolled in French schools (*Circulaire Valls*).

For operational examples of emergency medical aid and street-level healthcare mediation for undocumented populations, visit [Médecins du Monde](#).

8.2 Long-Term Solutions

Reintegration/Access to housing/Education programs/Family support

While immediate humanitarian relief is critical to ensuring daily survival, it does not address the structural causes of poverty. To truly protect undocumented children, we must shift from a model of short-term emergency management to a strategy of permanent social reintegration. Sustainable solutions require action across four fundamental axes:

[Housing Stability] → [Socio-Professional Reintegration] → [Continuous Education] → [Legal Security]

- **Holistic Social Reintegration:** True reintegration requires looking at the family unit as a whole. It involves moving families away from isolated street life and actively connecting them to local community life. This is achieved through social inclusion programs, such as registering families at neighborhood community centers (*maisons de quartier*), enrolling children in local sports associations, and organizing cultural exchange workshops where families can build local friendships.
- **Access to Stable and Sustainable Housing:** Moving families out of unheated squats, dangerous street camps, or unstable emergency hotel rooms is the absolute prerequisite for any long-term progress. We advocate for and invest in transitional housing programs (*logement passerelle*) and citizen-led solidary hosting networks. A stable home address provides children with a safe, quiet space to study, ensures proper hygiene, guarantees restorative sleep, and gives the family a legal domicile (*domiciliation*) required for all formal administrative procedures.
- **Long-Term Inclusive Education Programs:** Education is the most powerful tool to break the cycle of generational poverty. Long-term educational solutions go far

beyond the first day of school. They require continuous academic mentorship to help children overcome language barriers, digital equity (providing laptops and internet routers), and higher education guidance (*Parcoursup* or vocational training paths like *Apprentissage/CAP*).

- **Comprehensive Family Support and Parental Empowerment:** We cannot protect the child without empowering the parents. Long-term solutions must focus on giving mothers and fathers the autonomy to support their own families. This involves intensive French language classes (*FLE — Français Langue Étrangère*), long-term psychological and trauma care, and socio-professional guidance to identify industries facing labor shortages (*métiers en tension*) where regularization through work is possible.

To see how sustainable housing models are developed to end homelessness and extreme poverty for marginalized families, study the initiatives by the [Fondation Abbé Pierre](#).

8.3 What Citizens Can Do

Volunteer/Donate/Share information/Support ethical initiatives

You do not need to be a full-time humanitarian professional to make a profound difference in the life of an undocumented child. Civil society is built on the aggregation of small, ethical actions. Here is how everyday citizens can take action:

1. **Volunteer Your Time and Skills:** Time is the most valuable asset you can give. You can join local street outreach teams, drive supply distribution vans, or use professional skills like translation (especially Arabic, Romani, Pashto, or Dari), graphic design for awareness campaigns, or legal training to help families build residency files.
2. **Donate Responsibly:** Financial contributions allow associations to buy specific emergency goods (like targeted medical supplies or transit tickets). If you prefer material donations, focus on high-quality, practical items: sturdy strollers, new school supplies, intact winter shoes, and unexpired infant formula.
3. **Share Validated Information:** In the digital age, fighting ignorance is crucial. Use your personal social media platforms to amplify the voices of grassroots organizations, share articles debunking migrant myths, and raise awareness about the legal right to education for all children in France.
4. **Support Ethical Initiatives:** Align your daily consumer choices with human rights. Support local businesses that offer employment training to refugees, buy from fair-trade solidarity shops, and vote for municipal initiatives that fund emergency winter shelters and school cafeteria subsidies for low-income families.

For a great example of an interactive platform showing citizens how to easily match their skills with NGO volunteer needs, look at [France Bénévolat](#).

8.4 Working Together

Partnerships/Schools/Social workers/Other NGOs

No single association can solve child poverty in isolation. True, sustainable impact relies on a dense ecosystem of institutional and non-profit partnerships:

[Schools] + [Social Workers] + [Our Association] + [Partner NGOs] = Total Protection Circle

Partnerships with Local Schools: Teachers and school principals are often the first to notice when an undocumented child is struggling, missing class, or showing signs of malnutrition. We work directly with schools to provide discreet support, such as paying for school lunches or organizing after-school tutoring on school grounds.

Collaboration with Professional Social Workers: Municipal and state social workers are overwhelmed by bureaucratic demands. Our association acts as an agile ally on the ground, helping them identify isolated families, escorting parents to social security appointments, and handling immediate logistical emergencies that state budgets cannot cover.

Synergy with Other NGOs: We do not reinvent the wheel; we connect with existing expertise. We partner with specialized structures like *Médecins du Monde* for free healthcare access, *Le Secours Populaire* for large-scale food logistics, and localized legal clinics (*les permanences juridiques*) to ensure families receive the highest quality structural support possible.

Discover how nationwide networks coordinate massive food drives and solidarity partnerships by checking [Secours Populaire Français](#).

9. Our Actions on the Field

9.1 Street Outreach Missions

Meeting families/Distributing supplies/Identifying urgent needs

Our field operations are organized around regular, disciplined **Street Outreach Missions (Maraudes)**. Every week, our teams walk through targeted neighborhoods where families are known to spend their days.

The primary objective is not simply material distribution, but **vulnerability mapping**. Our volunteers use localized assessments to identify pregnant women, newborns, and children showing signs of severe psychological distress or physical illness. By consistently showing up, we build the deep trust required to coax deeply frightened, suspicious families out of hiding and into safe support systems.

9.2 Donation Campaigns

School kits/Food drives/Winter support

Our donation drives are strictly aligned with the school and seasonal calendars to provide practical utility when families need it most:

- **The "Solidarity Backpack" Campaign (July–August):** We plan to collect and distribute new school kits containing backpacks, notebooks, geometry sets, and pencil cases. This ensures that on the first day of school, an undocumented child looks exactly like any other student, protecting them from instant social stigma.
- **The "Winter Shield" Initiative (October–March):** A critical survival campaign providing high-calorie baby food, heavy winter coats, insulated blankets, and chemical hand-warmers to children forced to sleep in unheated squats or street corners.

For inspiration on organizing massive, nationwide material collection campaigns for back-to-school drives, read about the yearly campaigns run by [Restos du Cœur](#).

9.3 Monthly Impact Reports

Families helped/Supplies distributed/Volunteer participation

We maintain absolute operational transparency by publishing detailed data trackers every single month. This allows our community to track exactly how resources are allocated and measure our field efficiency.

Operational Indicator	Current Monthly Average	Next Quarter Target	Key Focus Area
Active Families Tracked	55 families	75 families	Street outreach expansion
School Supply Kits Delivered	140 kits	250 kits	Primary & Middle schools
Emergency Infant Hygiene Kits	90 kits	150 kits	Diapers & sensitive skin wipes
Successful School Enrollments	12 children	20 children	Overcoming municipal denials
Accompanied Medical Appointments	35 appointments	50 appointments	Utilizing PASS & AME systems

9.4 Future Projects

Educational workshops/Emergency support programs/Child-focused initiatives

Our Future Projects: Scaling Up Our Long-Term Impact

While we are still building our first programs, our strategic vision focuses on developing sustainable, empowering spaces for the near future. We are actively raising funds and building partnerships for three major upcoming initiatives:

- **Educational Support Workshops:** We plan to launch specialized, pop-up learning spaces close to temporary settlements and squats. These workshops will offer intensive French as a Foreign Language (FLE) courses for both children and their parents, digital literacy training using donated laptops, and creative art-therapy spaces to help children process migration trauma.
- **Emergency Support Programs:** To bridge the critical gap when families are evicted from squats or turned away by the saturated 115 emergency housing hotline, we are designing a "Solidarity Hosting Network". This program will vet and train citizen volunteers willing to open a spare bedroom to a mother and child for short-term emergency stays during severe winter weather.
- **Child-Focused Solidarity Initiatives:** Every child has a right to play and explore. We are establishing partnerships with local cultural centers, sports clubs, and museums to organize monthly "Discovery Days". These outings will give undocumented children access to football tournaments, museum visits, and holiday camps, ensuring they experience the joys of a normal, carefree childhood away from the stress of administrative precarity.

10. International & Social Perspectives

10.1 Child Poverty in Europe

Comparisons/Different support systems

A Comparative Analysis

Undocumented child poverty is a structural crisis cutting across the entire European Union. While the European Child Guarantee was established to ensure every child in poverty has access to healthcare and education, its implementation varies wildly regarding undocumented populations:

France: Offers strong theoretical access to education and basic medical safety nets like the *Aide Médicale d'État (AME)*, but families face extreme administrative delays and severe emergency housing shortages.

Spain: Features localized programs like *Padrón* registration, which allows undocumented families to register their residence easily, granting smoother access to regional healthcare and schooling networks.

Other European Regions: In several countries, strict internal immigration controls mean that accessing a hospital or a school can trigger an automatic report to immigration authorities, driving families into dangerous, deep isolation.

10.2 Migration & Childhood

Causes of migration/Vulnerabilities

For worldwide research and statistical dashboards covering child migration flows and safety tracking, visit the [UNICEF Data Portal](#).

10.3 Global Solutions

Successful initiatives/NGO examples/International cooperation

Successful Initiatives and Inspiring Models

Looking beyond local borders reveals innovative, highly successful frameworks that prove child-first immigration policies benefit society as a whole. International cooperation and grassroots networks offer excellent blueprints for our own association:

- **The "Sanctuary Cities" Model:** In various global municipalities, local governments have passed strict separation laws (*firewalls*). These policies ensure that public schools, local clinics, and municipal social services are legally forbidden from sharing data with national border enforcement agencies. This guarantees that undocumented parents can take their sick child to an emergency room or enroll them in school without the terrifying fear of deportation.
- **Inspirational NGO Examples:**
 - *PICUM (Platform for International Cooperation on Undocumented Migrants):* A powerful Brussels-based network that successfully campaigns for the human rights of undocumented children across Europe, providing legal tools and policy recommendations to the European Parliament.

- *Save the Children (Migration Programs)*: Operates specialized "Child-Friendly Spaces" in high-transit border zones and major European cities, offering psychological support, safety, and informal education to children in transit.
- **The Power of International Cooperation**: Transnational problems require cooperative solutions. Cross-border networks of NGOs allow for better tracking of unaccompanied minors, the sharing of best practices regarding language integration, and unified advocacy to force international bodies (like the European Union) to enforce the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child over national border security agendas.

11. Get Involved

11.1 Become a Volunteer

Types of missions/Skills needed/Registration process

Change is a collective journey, and our fieldwork relies entirely on human solidarity. Our association offers diverse volunteering opportunities tailored to your schedule, skills, and comfort level. We split our actions into three distinct types of missions:

- **On-the-Ground Outreach**: Joining our weekly street maraudes, managing the logistics of food trucks, or distributing blankets and infant hygiene kits directly to families in need.
- **Educational & Social Mentorship**: Providing after-school tutoring for children, teaching French (*FLE*) to parents, or accompanying families to their school enrollment appointments at the town hall.
- **Back-Office Support**: Assisting with legal file compilation, writing content for this blog, managing our social media platforms, or organizing graphic assets for our seasonal campaigns.

No professional humanitarian background is required to join us. The main **skills needed** are empathy, active listening, consistency, and a non-judgmental attitude. For specialized roles, language skills (such as Arabic, Romani, Pashto, or Dari) or a legal background are highly valued. Our **registration process** is simple: prospective volunteers fill out a short online form, attend an introductory orientation webinar, and complete a mandatory shadow-shift alongside an experienced team leader during a field mission to ensure they feel safe and confident.

For an excellent example of how nationwide networks onboard, train, and guide citizens through their initial volunteering steps, explore the portal of JeVeuxAider.gouv.fr.

11.2 Donate

Financial donations/Material donations/Sponsorship programs

To maintain our operational independence and react instantly to emergencies, our actions require continuous material and economic resources. Your generosity can take several impactful forms:

- **Financial Donations:** One-time or monthly monetary gifts are the most flexible way to support our cause. They allow us to buy targeted emergency goods, purchase transit tickets for families attending medical appointments, or fund legal fees for residency applications.
- **Material Donations:** We intend to organize targeted collection drives. We do not accept random items; instead, we focus on high-quality, essential survival gear. This includes sturdy strollers, unused school supplies, heavy winter coats, intact thermal shoes, unexpired infant formula, and diapers.
- **Sponsorship Programs (*Parrainage*):** For a deeper impact, citizens can join our family sponsorship network. This program pairs a donor with a specific student to cover all their educational costs throughout the school year, including cafeteria fees, school trips, clothing, and digital learning devices.

[€15] → Provides 3 nutritious, warm meals for a child through community kitchen programmes (Essential Meals)

[€35] → Funds a School First kit: school materials, notebooks, and French learning resources for one child

[€75] → Delivers an Emergency Support kit with food, hygiene essentials, and winter items for a family reached through street outreach

[€150] → Sponsors one full month for a child in our programme: school kit, meals, transport, and hygiene (Sponsor a Month)

To learn more about secure donation handling, tax deductions, and how humanitarian funds are managed transparently for donor trust, review the guidelines on [Dons en Confiance](#).

11.3 Share the Message

Social media/Awareness campaigns/Events

Not everyone can afford to give time or money, but everyone has a voice. Amplifying our message is a powerful, cost-free way to fight the institutional invisibility that traps undocumented children. You can advocate for our cause through three main channels:

- **Social Media Advocacy:** Follow our accounts, share our monthly impact reports, and repost our articles debunking migrant myths. Breaking the algorithm of indifference helps humanize these children in the public eye.
- **Grassroots Awareness Campaigns:** Help us distribute educational flyers in local community centers, universities, and libraries to inform the general public about the legal right to education for all minors in France.
- **Solidarity Events:** Participate in or help us organize charity concerts, solidarity runs, photo exhibitions documenting street life, and debate panels. These public gatherings raise essential funds while building an inclusive community fabric.

To see how international youth movements build digital toolkits and run highly effective online campaigns to defend children's human rights, visit the [Amnesty International Youth Campaign Network](#).

12. Conclusion

12.1 Our Commitment

Protecting childhood/Promoting dignity/Building long-term solutions

Our association was founded on a simple, non-negotiable human principle: **a child is a child first, and an administrative status should never dictate their right to a dignified life.** We refuse to accept a society where young children are forced to sleep on concrete, search for food, or hide from the school system out of fear.

Our unwavering commitment is built upon three core pillars:

- **Protecting Childhood:** Preserving the right of every minor to play, learn, grow up in a safe environment, and be shielded from the psychological stresses of adult administrative precarity.
- **Promoting Dignity:** Ensuring that every family we meet is treated with absolute respect, horizontal solidarity, and the fundamental rights guaranteed by international human treaties.
- **Building Long-Term Solutions:** Refusing to settle for temporary band-aids. We promise to keep pushing for permanent housing stability, educational equity, and legal regularisation until emergency street outreach is no longer necessary.

| OUR UNWAVERING PROMISE |

1. Every child must have a school desk, a warm bed, and a hot meal.
2. No administrative paperwork should ever strip a minor of safety.
3. We will act as a shield on the field until the system changes.

To read structural policy declarations regarding the eradication of extreme child precarity and homelessness in Europe, study the official goals outlined in the [European Child Guarantee](#).

12.2 Final Message

To close this detailed plan, we must remember that institutional invisibility only exists if we choose to look away. Poverty is a circumstance, not an identity, and administrative boundaries should never override human rights. Shifting from indifference to active solidarity is a collective choice that starts with a single action.

“No child should grow up invisible. Together, we can look beyond the status, see the child, and build a future beyond survival.”

If you are ready to take the first step with us, read our final roadmap and join the solidarity movement today via our [SIDE](#) and join us today !